

Databricks - Share Genie spaces beyond the workspace user guide

Private Preview

Preview terms

- The product is in private preview, is not intended for use in production, and is provided AS-IS consistent with your agreement with Databricks.
- Although the preview is not intended for use in production, you may still incur charges for platform usage DBUs.
- Non-public information about the preview (including the fact that there is a preview for the feature/product itself) is confidential.
- We may change or discontinue the preview at any time without notice. We may also choose not to make the preview generally commercially available.
- We may charge for this preview offering in the future.
- Previews are not included in the SLA and do not have formal support. **If you have questions or feedback, please reach out to your Databricks contact.**

Feature Summary

This feature allows Genie creators to share Genie spaces to users and groups registered with the Databricks account who are not members of the originating workspace. This is equivalent to "view only users" in other tools. This way, business users can use Genie without having to be onboarded into a workspace. This feature will be enabled at the account level.

To use this feature, you must first complete the [prerequisites](#). Next, you must enable the embedded credentials in the Settings page and share the Space to account level users. These users can then open a link to the Genie space, authenticate via your identity provider, and start asking questions.

Embedding credentials will create one service principal that mirrors the last editor's permission attached tables only. The last editor is the person who most recently edited the Genie settings such as changing warehouse, list of attached tables, descriptions, etc. Modifications to instructions do not make a user the "last editor." This means that if a new edit is made after sharing, the embedded credentials for account-level users will update to those of the most recent editor. This credential is then used to answer all Space users questions.

This document describes some capabilities in private preview and thus subject to the confidentiality of the preview agreement. If you have any questions, please contact your Databricks account team.

Example:

- Alan and Bob are workspace users who have created & edited a Genie space that is ready for business users.
- Jack and Jill are business users who don't have workspace access, but they are registered to the account.
- If Bob chooses "embedded credentials" and then shares Genie space with Jack and Jill, Jack and Jill's use will leverage Bob's permissions.
- If Alan adds a new table to the space the next day, Jack and Jill's users will update to leverage Alan's permissions.
- If Bob then goes in and edits the instructions, but doesn't change any Genie settings, Jack and Jill will still leverage Alan's permissions.

This also means that row-level masking and security for different user groups would require multiple Genie spaces.

In order for Jack and Jill to have access to different subsets of rows and columns on attached tables at this juncture of the preview, Bob would have to:

- Create a 1st set of views aligned with Jack's intended data permissions (rows/columns)
- Use that 1st set of views in Genie space 1
- Share Genie space 1 to Jack.
- Create a 2nd set of views aligned with Jill's intended data permissions (rows/columns)
- Use that 2nd set of views in Genie space 2
- Share Genie space 2 to Jill.

Prerequisites

The following are required to share Genie spaces to non-workspace users:

- Must be an AWS or (non GFM) Azure account
- Unified login must be enabled ([link](#))
- The users/groups that you want to share Genie spaces with must be synced from your identity provider to your Databricks account ([link](#))
- Databricks must enable the capability after you accept the preview terms

How do I share Genie spaces with account-level users/groups?

When the prerequisites are met, follow this process to share your Genie space with account-level users/groups:

1. As a Genie space creator, ensure you have following permissions:
 - a. Genie space: "Can Manage" permissions to share the Genie space with other users

This document describes some capabilities in private preview and thus subject to the confidentiality of the preview agreement. If you have any questions, please contact your Databricks account team.

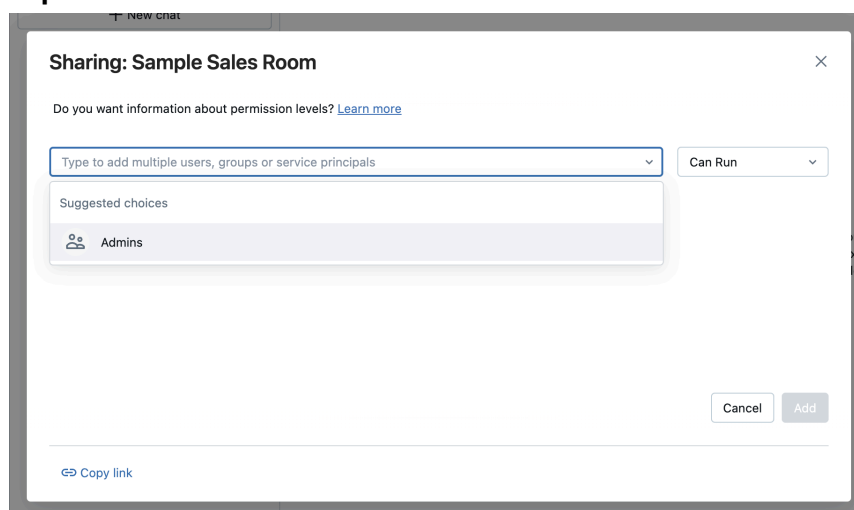
- b. Attached SQL warehouse: "Can Use" or above permissions on the warehouse
 - c. Included tables: "Select" or above permissions on all of the tables added to the Genie space
2. You must first enable embedded credentials in the Settings page of your Genie space. This setting means all Space users will leverage the credential of the last space editor for data and compute.

Run As Setting

When sharing the space with other users, select whether to embed the publishing user's credentials, or to use the viewer's credentials

- ☐ Viewer
- ☒ Embedded Credentials

- a.
 - b. Note that this will apply to workspace users as well as account level users.
3. Then, click the Share button in the upper-right corner of your Genie space. Enter the names of the account-level users/groups that you want to share the Genie space with. **Choose the "Can Run" permission level.**



- a.
- b. The "Can Run" permission level is necessary to actually ask questions and receive answers.
- c. **Note:** if you share account-level users on "Can Edit" or "Can Manage" permissions, account users won't see the Instructions or Settings page in the UI. However, if they manually edit the URL, they could gain access to those pages. If the user is ever added to the workspace at a future date, then they will have "Can Edit" or "Can Manage" as designated in the modal.

This document describes some capabilities in private preview and thus subject to the confidentiality of the preview agreement. If you have any questions, please contact your Databricks account team.

How do I access Genie spaces as an account-level user?

Once your Genie space has been shared with an account-level user, they will need the link to the Genie space. Make sure to share the link generated by the “Copy link” button in the Sharing modal.

Sharing: Sample Sales Room ×

Do you want information about permission levels? [Learn more](#)

Type to add multiple users, groups or service principals ▼

People with access

 Hanlin Sun	Can Manage (inherited)
 Admins	Can Manage (inherited)
 All workspace users	Can Run ▼
 Alnur Ali	Can Manage ▼
 Arik Fraimovich	Can Manage ▼

[🔗 Copy link](#)

Once they open the link to the Genie space, they will be prompted to authenticate via your identity provider. Once authenticated, the Genie space will open.

Account-level users will see a simplified UI that displays only the Genie space. All other workspace features are removed from this interface, allowing account-level users to focus on querying data without being exposed to the rest of a workspace’s complexity.

With “Can Run” permissions, account-level users can only: ask questions, get tabular and chart responses, and provide thumbs/up down feedback. They cannot access instructions.

FAQs

- What if a business user at the account level sends the link to another business user at the account level?
 - Account-level users cannot grant new users access to the Genie space. Only workspace users with "Can Manage" permissions can share a Genie space with others.
 - If an account-level user shares a link to a Genie space with another account-level user, the recipient will only be able to access the Genie space if they were previously granted access. If they have not been, they will see an error.

This document describes some capabilities in private preview and thus subject to the confidentiality of the preview agreement. If you have any questions, please contact your Databricks account team.

- What happens if an account user is shared with Can Manage or Can Edit permissions, and then they are added to the workspace later?
 - They will then be able to utilize their “Can Edit” or “Can Manage” permissions. Account users are restricted to just asking questions to a Genie space and providing thumbs up/down feedback.
- How does account user activity appear in the Genie monitoring page?
 - Currently, the questions asked by account users are logged on the Monitoring page, but the User column will be blank. In the future, the User column will display the actual account user’s username.
- How does account user activity appear in the query history UI and query history system table?
 - The Query History UI today will show the queries generated by account users, but the User column will display the service principal name.
 - In the future, the User column will display the actual account user’s username.
- Are account user activities emitted in the audit log?
 - Audit logs are not currently available for Genie but are planned in the future.
- What happens if an account user is shared with Can Manage or Can Edit permissions, and then they are added to the workspace later?
 - They will then be able to utilize their “Can Edit” or “Can Manage” permissions. Account users are restricted to just asking questions to a Genie space and providing thumbs up/down feedback.
- How do I remove access from an account user/group?
 - A workspace user who has “Can Manage” permissions has the power to revoke access for account users (just like workspace users).
 - To do so, they simply open the Share modal in the Genie space and remove the user/group.
- What happens when I choose to “Embed credentials”?
 - Embedding credentials will create one service principal that mirrors the last editor’s permission attached tables only (effectively downscoped from the editor’s full data permissions).
 - Rather than embedding the user’s full credential (e.g. to all tables), we auto-generate a service principal that mirrors the user’s credential only on the small number of tables attached to the Genie space.
 - The service principal’s permissions are also always current to the last editing user - if the last editor loses permissions, it will be updated in the service principal.
 - This service principal is protected and owned by the system so cannot be modified or deleted by any one in the account or workspace.
- What if I want different account users to have access to different rows and columns in attached tables (apply data permissions of the account user)?
 - This currently requires the creation of multiple Genie spaces.
 - In order for Jack and Jill to have access to different subsets of rows and columns on attached tables at this juncture of the preview, Bob would have to:

This document describes some capabilities in private preview and thus subject to the confidentiality of the preview agreement. If you have any questions, please contact your Databricks account team.

- Create a 1st set of views aligned with Jack's intended data permissions (rows/columns)
 - Use that 1st set of views in Genie space 1
 - Share Genie space 1 to Jack.
 - Create a 2nd set of views aligned with Jill's intended data permissions (rows/columns)
 - Use that 2nd set of views in Genie space 2
 - Share Genie space 2 to Jill.
- What if the last editor has some of their necessary permissions revoked?
 - If the last editor loses some necessary permissions, all users will lose the ability to ask questions to their Genie space.
 - Permission changes that can result in loss of functionality:
 - Last editor loses permissions to a table attached to the space
 - Last editor loses permission to the warehouse attached to the space
 - Last editor loses permission to the space itself or the broader workspace
 - Space itself is deleted, all users will also lose access to the space
 - In order to restore functionality, a new editor must save a change and update the embedded credential to be that of a service principal mirroring their own.
- How does Genie share to account compare to Dashboard share to account?
 - Similarities:
 - Both allow you to share to account-level users without adding them to the space
 - Both require your business users to be registered as Databricks account-level users
 - Differences:
 - Dashboard share to account uses the credentials of the dashboard publisher ([docs here](#)). Genie share to account users uses the credentials of the Genie space's last editor.
 - NOTE: Draft/publish for Genie is planned, and embedded credentials functionality will be updated in the future.
- Who do I contact if I run into issues or have feedback?
 - If you have feedback or encounter an issue not addressed in this user guide, please reach out to your Solutions Architect first and ask them to discuss with the product team supporting the preview.
 - Alternatively, as part of participating in this preview, you will have a session with the product team supporting this preview and can also raise there.